



Intel Core i7-13700HX, which features a base TDP of 55W.

Starting things off with processor performance, looking at general productivity with the PCMark 10 benchmark, we can see that the new Ryzen 9 actually performs better than the 13th gen i7 almost across the board, save one field.

We use the Cinebench R23 benchmark to test single-thread and multi-thread performance. Here, while the 13th gen Core i7-13700HX performs better in single-thread performance, the Ryzen 9 ends up scoring higher in multi-thread performance.

When it comes to encryption and decryption, for which we use WinRAR and 7-Zip's benchmark tools, the 13th gen Core i7 slightly inches ahead of the Ryzen 9 in the WinRAR benchmark, but with 7-Zip, the Ryzen 9 takes the win by a landslide.

Overall, the Ryzen 9 7940HS comes out as the better performing processor between the two.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

Next we come to gaming performance. Both laptops feature NVIDIA RTX 4070s, however, the TGP on the HP OMEN Transcend 16 is slightly lower at 130W compared to the 140W on the Razer Blade 14.

That said, the difference in scores isn't all that big. As you can see, the 3DMark scores for both laptops are very close, but the higher TGP on the Razer Blade 14 does seem to have made a difference. The same translated to real-world

gaming as well. We tested both laptops across a range of games, both CPU and GPU intensive. The FPS numbers for the most part are very close, but the Razer Blade 14 inches ahead in most games. Except for Valorant. Valorant is weird.

Either way, the NVIDIA RTX 4070 is an excellent laptop GPU, and you should have no trouble running the latest AAA games with ease, even at the higher resolution display offered by the Razer Blade 14.

THERMALS AND BATTERY

Usually, laptops with small form factors, like the Razer Blade 14, tend to heat up a lot more than their larger gaming laptop counterparts. Surprisingly, the Razer Blade 14 handles heat exceptionally well, especially when compared to last year's model. This is thanks to both the slightly larger size, and the presence of the new Max Fan mode profile in Razer Synapse, which keeps the laptop surprisingly cool under stress. Of course, the Max Fan mode also makes the laptop pretty loud.

During our CPU stress test, we recorded a peak CPU temp of 76 degrees Celsius, which is great. Similarly, surface temps across the laptop never went across the 40 degree Celsius mark. Do keep in mind that all of our thermal testing is done in an airconditioned environment, so the laptop would run hotter sans the AC.

At approximately 90 minutes, the 68Wh battery on the Razer Blade 14 has the best battery life we've tested

in a gaming laptop this year. That's 90 minutes of just gaming.

This is of course with the refresh rate set to 60 Hz. At 240 Hz, the battery drains a LOT quicker. General productivity tasks, web browsing etc will net you a lot more time on the Razer Blade 14 while unplugged.

VERDICT

The Razer Blade 14 is a solid step-up from last year's variant, with better internals, a larger 16:10 display, removable RAM modules, and better cooling as well.

The accompanying display is excellent, and the new 7000 series AMD Ryzen 9 7940HS performs exceptionally with the RTX 4070. The 14-inch form factor makes this an extremely portable laptop offering, and the port options are also decent. It's quite a bummer that the laptop isn't officially available in India. You can buy it via third party sellers on e-commerce portals, but beware that there is no after sales support available in India. So, if you run into any issues with the device, you will need to rely on your local repair stores.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: AMD Ryzen 9 7940HS | TDP: 35W | GPU: NVIDIA RTX 4070 | TGP: 140W | RAM: 16GB DDR5-5600 | Display: 14-inch, 2560 x 1600, 240 Hz IPS panel | Storage: 1 TB SSD | Ports: 2 USB-A, 2-USB-C, 1 HDMI 2.1

CONTACT

Company: Razer | No official support in India | Website: <https://support.razer.com/>